



Becoming healthier is all about taking small steps such as turning vegetarian for a month, eating more cruciferous vegetables or including fitness in your daily regime

easily attainable, let's explore some of these changes.

First, Devgan recommends switching to a slightly low-fat diet in January after all the excesses of the holiday season. "Consciously avoid fried foods and sweets. This will give your kidney, liver and gut a little break," she says. "You could also focus on a vegetarian diet for a month to offload the festive excesses."

Second, focus on hydration. Make sure you are drinking 7-10 glasses of water every day. You can add other detox variants such as lemon-infused water, coconut water, green tea, etc., to it. This is a simple step but with far reaching consequences as far as your health is concerned.

Devgan says that it's not important for everyone to do everything but even if you make two or three changes, it will help keep you healthier. "Including a probiotic and a prebiotic food in your daily meal will help with gut health. Also cut down on salt and increase the amount of pepper and herbs for seasoning. Eat more cruciferous vegetables such as cabbage, cauliflower and broccoli. They add antioxidants to your diet and improve your immunity," she adds.

Improving your fitness and diet also has a positive impact on your mental health. A 2023 review of studies examining the effects of physical activity on mental health found that exercise may help reduce symptoms of anxiety and depression, boost one's mood and improve sleep quality.

The path to reinventing yourself may start off a little rocky, but you can always get back on track anytime throughout the year. So take those baby steps and celebrate the small wins towards a healthier you. Wishing you a Happy Healthy Year. **BT**

@smitabw